

Dominic Aquilina

Senior Front-End Engineer

I Build Experiences

Professional Summary

- **Senior full-stack engineer** with a heavy front-end lean, proficiency in design, and a deep empathy for the user
- **Adaptable and versatile**; proficient in a wide breadth of programming languages and frameworks
- Proven productivity in **Agile and high-autonomy** shops, with experience in start-ups, small dev teams, and enterprise
- Proactively prevents technical debt with **clean, consistent, and well-architected** code
- Dedicated to enhancing **digital literacy** and mastering emerging technologies to drive efficiency and innovation
- Designs performant **RESTful APIs** and algorithms optimised for **computational and spatial complexity**
- Keen eye for **UX**; able to efficiently remove barriers and simplify workflows without compromising features or quality
- Strong communicator focused on building alignment in **cross-functional teams**
- Adept at **interfacing with stakeholders** to convey technical information and gather requirements
- Committed to inclusive design and proficient with modern accessibility frameworks (**WCAG, WAI-ARIA, IITAA**)
- **Certified in cybersecurity** and educated in cryptography; knowledgeable of patterns which may introduce flaws
- Partner maintains **Top Secret clearance** with the Canadian Federal Government

Relevant Skills

- **Front-End Frameworks:**
 - **Angular:** 10+ years: metadata-driven forms app, connections app, data entry portal, shared component libraries, e-commerce landing pages for food suppliers, Personal Projects - wedding website, art projects
 - **React:** 2+ years - design systems, Maestro web client, Personal Projects - website builder
 - **Svelte:** 1 year - admin tooling and script authoring tool
- **Advanced Modern JavaScript/TypeScript:** 15+ years - pure-JS framework built via hackathon, Personal Projects
- **Automated Testing:** 8+ years - specialisation in ensuring that code pathways and edge cases are tested in meaningful ways without memory leaks (Jasmine, Jest, Protractor, Playwright, TestCafé)
- **API Development:** 3+ years - maintaining and adding features to internal APIs and actively participating in design discussions for greenfield API projects (Node.js, C#, Java, Python)
- **CI/CD:** 5+ years - authoring and maintaining GitHub actions, GitLab tasks, VSCode launch configurations, and npm pre-commit script chains; writing containerized development setups in Docker
- **AWS:** 5+ years - assets management via Amazon S3, CORS and CDN management via Amazon CloudFront, automated OCR via Amazon Textract, managing deployments via Amazon EC2, searching datasets via Amazon ECS
- **Mentorship:** charged with training junior engineers as well as mentoring technical designers (non-developers) in basic front-end development so that they could contribute to bug fixes and expand their core skillset
- **Documentation:** Technical and non-technical documentation for a variety of projects, including setup instructions, onboarding documentation, detailed bug reports, inline comments, and thorough code reviews
- **Web Design:** 8+ years - wireframes, feature redesigns, and even solo art projects in Figma; design of ad unit creative in Adobe Photoshop and InDesign; svg creation in InkScape
- **Cybersecurity:** Certified by Google; familiar with packet transfer protocols and sniffing techniques to do network security analysis
- **WebSockets:** 2+ years - multi-user collaboration tools for recording audio and authoring scripts or book transcriptions, batch job completion notifications
- **.NET:** 5+ years - C# production back-end systems for big data, EdTech; ASP.NET/Razor for building dynamic landing pages; VB.NET for GIS plugins

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Relevant Work Experience

Kibeam Learning - Senior Full-Stack Consultant

2025/03 - 2025/12

Ottawa, ON (Remote)

- **Reduced setup time from three weeks to 1 hour** for key stakeholders by **creating comprehensive onboarding and technical documentation** for the company's knowledge base to facilitate knowledge transfer
- Executed, coordinated, and monitored **simultaneous deployments of 3 or more projects** to facilitate the release of features which included changes to all parts of the stack
- Spearheaded upgrade of front-end applications to **Svelte 5** from Svelte 4, systematically transitioning features while improving application stability without introducing regressions
- Drastically improved **stability** and **user experience** for complex projects through redesign and technical audits
- Triaged and remedied performance and concurrency concerns in **multiple projects and programming languages**
- Wrote **CI/CD** tasks and the front-end's first **unit tests** to facilitate automation
- Diagnosed pain points and created actionable plans for improving tooling by **interfacing directly with internal stakeholders** in both a support and advocacy capacity
- **Mentored** technical designers on core programming principles and project architecture and participated in paired programming exercises to help them transition into junior developer roles

Svelte SvelteKit TypeScript JavaScript ESLint Vite Vitest Jest Prettier C# ReSharper socket.io Python CSS Tailwind PostCSS GitHub JIRA Auth0 WavPak PostgreSQL Docker VSCode Task Authoring GitHub Actions AWS Shell Postman Figma CORS TestFlight

Kinaxis - Senior Software Developer, Clients, Front-End Technologies

2024/09 - 2024/11

Kanata, ON (Hybrid)

- **Developed a lightweight and extensible JavaScript MVC framework** for building dynamic, API-driven web pages with JSON over the course of 4 days during the 2024 Kinaxis Hackathon
- Contributed to Maestro, an **enterprise-level software project**, in both JavaScript and Java
- Developed additional functionality for reusable components in the Kinaxis **design system**
- **Enhanced developer onboarding** materials by refining existing documentation

React styled-components TypeScript Jest TestCafe SCSS JavaScript Parcel Storybook C# Java MUI Figma BitBucket

Cinchy - Experiences Developer III

2022/11 - 2024/06

Ottawa, ON (Remote)

- **Removed complexity** and **eliminated previously untraceable errors** in the metadata-driven forms application, **reducing the investigation time** for new bugs from days to hours by Initiating a **major refactor**
- Crafted complex features within multiple applications of a large existing codebase with a strong emphasis on **usability** and **extensibility** while also **reducing technical debt** with every release
- Oversaw **simultaneous Angular upgrades** from versions 12 to 17 for 3 projects with shared dependencies
- **Documented** complex existing applications via inline comments, function descriptions, and **process documentation**, including a guide on how to write meaningful unit tests **without introducing memory leaks** and a multi-app Angular compatibility matrix
- Refactored deep, asynchronous processes to add **strong typing** and enforce **immutability** for custom form data to ensure that data passing between components remained accessible and consistent
- **Developed APIs and database queries** while collaborating with cross-functional teams, and helping coordinate data-centric solutions across the entire stack

Angular RxJS React TypeScript Jasmine SCSS JavaScript ASP.NET Razor C# Angular-Material Bootstrap SQL Docker Figma

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Relevant Work Experience

Shopliftr - Senior Developer

2017/09 - 2022/11

Ottawa, ON

- **Improve application stability, ensure data integrity** with validation decorators, and **reduce maintenance overhead** for new code by leading a major refactor of both **API and model layers** across the full stack
- **Wrote, maintained, and enforced UI/UX standards** for applications
- Designed new features in **Figma** and created for ad units in **Photoshop** as the lead designer
- **Improved unit test coverage by over 90%** for shared component library and data entry platform

Angular RxJS TypeScript Jasmine Protractor SCSS JavaScript Node.js Elasticsearch Java Angular-Material Figma Photoshop S3 CloudFront Git Postman

Other Noteworthy Roles and Projects

- **CV: The Movie** - My second attempt at a solution to the challenge of "build something interesting in Angular." I wanted a way to highlight some of my CV's points of interest while paying homage to my love of video games. This could very easily be expanded into a cutscene engine for an angular-based browser game (<https://cv-movie.dominicaquilina.com/>)
- **Algorithm Practice** - A catch-all repository for experimenting with various JavaScript algorithms, storing (and analysing the complexity of) leetcode solutions, and building a library of comprehensive regular expressions (<https://github.com/DAquilina/algorithm-practice>)
- **Kibeam Interactive Grid** - Created as part of Kibeam's technical assessment, written in vanilla JavaScript as a way of exploring the depth and performance of the language (<https://github.com/DAquilina/daquilina-kibeam>)
- **The Shavening** - Built in ~50 minutes given only the prompt "build something interesting in Angular." (<https://shavening.dominicaquilina.com>)
- **Shadows** - An art piece and an exploration of the power of CSS animations created as an anniversary present for my partner (<https://shadows.dominicaquilina.com/>)
- **Animatronic Sorting Hat**: A CLI app developed in Python for a self-contained system driven by a Raspberry Pi; involved custom wiring and sewing a servo-controlled custom machined jaw into a hat enclosure and writing a Python service to ingest sound bytes and synchronise the jaw's movement as they played
- **Local Line** - Front-End Web Developer; created a modal-stacking architecture to patch a hole in the AngularJS library's core functionality (SREDable)
- **Sault Ste. Marie Innovation Centre** - Co-op engineer; work with ArcGIS/ArcMaps as part of the core business, and gained a deep knowledge of accessible design through the creation of the *Vulnerable Persons Registry*
- **Research Entrepreneurs Accelerating Prosperity** - Developer with the Blister Games Team
- **Ferko Liblik** - Developed business intelligence dashboards for major financial institutions, including live insights into user metrics
- **Charity Republic** - Freelance Web Developer; Mentorship of high school volunteers
- **Waterloo Public Interest Research Group** - Volunteer and Web Developer
- **Food Not Bombs Kitchener/Waterloo**: Found during operation Desert Storm as a protest against government spending on militarisation instead of meeting the basic human needs of its citizens, FNB provides weekly meals to share with the community using produce that would otherwise go to waste.
- **Linux** - Extensive familiarity with Linux shell environments, both via WSL and native *nix terminals; previously used Kubuntu as primary OS and experience managing BIOS for dual booting and startup optimisations
- **Breadth of Experience** - Experience with JavaScript, TypeScript, Angular, React, Svelte, RxJS, Node.js, C, C++, C#, Python, Java, ASP.NET/Razor, SQL, shell scripts, assembly, Ruby on Rails, Visual Basic

Education

- **Bachelor of Applied Science, Computer Engineering**, Honours, Co-Op, University of Waterloo
- **Google Cybersecurity Certificate**, Google Career Certificate via Coursera

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